

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1302

By Boyd

A RESOLUTION to honor Gwyn Jennings on the occasion of her retirement from teaching.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in paying tribute to a professional educator who has devoted her life to classroom instruction, always maintaining a nurturing, disciplined, and joyful culture of learning for her students; and

WHEREAS, Gwyn Jennings has taught at Coles Ferry Elementary School in the Lebanon Special School District for her entire thirty-four-year career, serving as a first grade teacher for twenty years before becoming the school's technology instructor; and

WHEREAS, as a first grade teacher, Ms. Jennings designed and implemented a comprehensive literacy program that was focused on early intervention and diagnostic assessment; she also tutored students in reading for many years, continuing this practice after she transitioned to her new position; and

WHEREAS, for the past fourteen years, Ms. Jennings has been responsible for the school-wide technology curriculum for grades K-5, and in this role, she has ensured that digital literacy is always balanced with academic rigor and that technology serves as a tool for creativity and problem-solving; and

WHEREAS, she has also served as Cole Ferry's social media coordinator and produced a student television show, "CFE tv"; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Jennings's excellence as an instructor and classroom leader has been duly recognized; she has been twice honored as Teacher of the Year at Coles Ferry (2007 and 2021), and she was selected District Teacher of the Year in 2007; and

WHEREAS, Gwyn Jennings is also renowned for her leadership among her peers; she has diligently mentored many young teachers through peer professional development and student-teacher coaching; and

WHEREAS, a devout Christian, Ms. Jennings helped found the Fellowship of Christian Athletes program at Coles Ferry; she practices her faith at Rural Hill Church of Christ, where she serves as children's education curriculum coordinator and teacher; and

WHEREAS, this exemplary educator earned her Bachelor of Science degree in Education from Tennessee Technological University and a Master of Science degree in Reading from Middle Tennessee State University; and

WHEREAS, Gwyn Jennings is retiring from her duties at the end of the school year; we acknowledge that although her teaching position will be filled, she can never truly be replaced; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor Gwyn Jennings on the occasion of her retirement from teaching, salute her thirty-four years spent nurturing the growth of young minds at Coles Ferry Elementary School, and extend to her our best wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.